The Void Throne

PLAYER GUIDE | VERSION 0.2 | 13 OCTOBER 2026

We have won an empire. Now we must decide what we are prepared to keep doing to hold it.

By John Keyworth, developed with Codex. Five players, one facilitator, 60 minutes. A paper game: use cards, pens and three counters. No electronic equipment is needed to play.

The situation

You meet at **the Seam**. Reports from **the Narrow**, a route serving the Vethis region, describe a failing beacon installation, a stranded field cohort and communities living on diminishing stores. Armed Conclave remnants threaten traffic. The occupation of Vethis has already lasted fourteen years. Its civilian opposition is not the remnant force.

Each round represents **one month** of operations before the final Ceremony. The eight-minute briefing opens this period of provisional government; it is not a literal day of instant interstellar travel. The local emergency and all named assets in this pack are new prototype scenario material.

The settlement

You negotiate the two outstanding Navigation and Military instruments of the wider Charter. For this scenario, the other institutions have accepted all six printed alternatives. The Ecclesiatum will sanctify any package ratified by the three played parties, and the remaining formalities are secured. No additional veto will appear.

Players	Council seats
Ductus Guild: two	One at Navigation and Supply; one at Security and Government
Janissariat: two	One at each council
Ascendant: one	Security and Government; sends written directives to Navigation

The clock

Minutes	Activity
00-08	Briefing and seating
08-26	Round one: faction 5, councils 7, free discussion 6
26-44	Round two: faction 5, councils 7, free discussion 6
44-54	Ceremony: final instruments and signatures
54-60	Debrief

Contents: rules pp. 2-3; faction briefs pp. 4-6; assets p. 7; councils p. 8; decision cards pp. 9-10; Charter options pp. 11-12; Ascendant worksheet p. 13; public board p. 14; settlement p. 15. Hidden consequences and four visions are in the facilitator pack.

From commitment to consequence

PLAYER GUIDE | PHASES AND AUTHORITY

1. Faction discussion - five minutes

Agree both asset assignments on your faction card. Both teammates sign. Put each asset beside its selected assignment. The bell locks these choices. A council can use only assets offered to it; an imperial directive cannot seize a withheld asset. Discuss your priorities before your delegates separate.

The Ascendant privately chooses this round's Navigation or Security vision and may lodge the **Grey Petrel** on one printed intervention. Both choices lock at the faction bell. A missed vision means none; a missing intervention means Keep. An untriggered reserve returns at round end.

2. Councils - seven minutes

Navigation chooses one order. Security chooses one order. Circle the order and obtain the initials required by the authority at the **start of the round**. The Ascendant may send and revise written directives until the bell. The final council card is binding. Spoken instructions and superseded notes have no effect.

Round one: the Ascendant chooses both operational orders. Each council also proposes one provisional article. Both delegates and the Ascendant must separately sign it. It takes effect in round two. Without all three, that domain remains Interim.

Round two: N-G gives Navigation to the Guild; N-I to the Ascendant; N-J to both delegates. M-I gives Security to the Ascendant; M-A to the Janissariat; M-J to both delegates. Interim means Ascendant. No mid-round article change is allowed.

Under joint authority, both delegates must initial. Missing, multiple or unauthorised orders default to **Hold** at Navigation or **Restraint** at Security. There is no penalty for invalidity alone. An otherwise valid order missing its required asset defaults and causes **Communities -1**. Committed assets cannot be reassigned after a default.

3. Free discussion - six minutes

The facilitator resolves both councils and independent assignments together, announces effects and returns the cards. After round one, post the provisional articles. Use the remaining time to negotiate. Promises do not move assets or change completed orders.

Law and physical power

The Guild can send Wayfarer on its own commercial voyage. The Janissariat can order an independent Raid. Neither requires another player's approval. A Charter obligation can make the act a breach; it does not prevent the attempt. Each faction that breaks its printed duty causes **Communities -1, at most once per round**. This stacks with operational effects.

Each asset has one assignment per round. Vigil cannot serve a Warrant and a council Guard. A Grey Petrel Relief lift can operate alongside Wayfarer's private voyage: these are two ships and cause two points of beacon wear.

Defaults

An unsigned or missing Guild card means **Wayfarer Trade; Lantern Maintain**. An unsigned or missing Janissariat card means **Spear Stand down; Vigil Home**. A missing or multiple asset selection uses that asset's default. Absent applies only to lost/disabled assets; it is not a voluntary choice. Their duties can still be broken. No faction is eliminated.

What the counters mean

PLAYER GUIDE | PUBLIC CONSEQUENCES

Track: 0-4	Start	Meaning
Beacon	2	The Narrow installation: relay, surveillance and traffic-control capacity. It does not measure the health of the immaterial deep.
Communities	3	Local stores and confidence in the settlement.
Readiness	3	The Janissariat's conditioned combat power. Food and ordinary escort duty cannot restore it.

Prepare the route, then use it

First add **Lantern Maintain +1 Beacon**, or a funded **Repair +2 Beacon**. These cannot both use Lantern. Limit this prepared value to 0-4. A voyage needs **prepared Beacon 2+**. Below 2 a council voyage halts, gives no cargo or military passage and causes Communities -1. A private Trade simply returns without a contract. Neither causes wear.

Each council voyage that crosses causes **Beacon -1**. A private Trade that crosses causes a further -1, even if attacked. Check all voyages against the same prepared value. Apply wear after every voyage is checked. There are no fees, abstract capacity points or transfers between assets.

Local survival and military power

Every round: Communities -1 as stores run down. Then add all cargo, Guard, operation, breach and hidden effects. Limit Communities to 0-4 once, at the end.

If Spear actually fights through a successful Campaign or Raid, **Readiness +1**. Otherwise **Readiness -1**. Apply this once per round and limit to 0-4. Use **opening Readiness** for strength checks and Warrants. Routine Guard is protection and deterrence, not a conditioning exercise.

A Campaign needs delivered Military or Shared passage. It causes Communities -1 and fights successfully at opening Readiness 2+. Below 2, Spear is overmatched and disabled. Without delivered passage, the Campaign does not leave: Communities -1; no combat. Spear remains intact.

A Raid costs Communities -1 for disruption even if it misses. Whether the remnant target appears is a hidden fixed condition. If present and opening Readiness is 2+, it fights and causes a further Communities -1. If present below 2, Spear is disabled; no further Community loss. A missing target does not disable Spear.

Independent trade and physical protection

Wayfarer Trade completes one commercial contract if prepared Beacon is 3+, or if it is 2 and Vigil provides Guard/Warrant protection. At 2 without protection, attackers disable Wayfarer and the contract fails. Its crew survives. A contract is recorded on the board; it cannot be spent, gifted or converted into another asset.

A Guard or valid Warrant uses Vigil, gives Communities +1 and supplies **guarded** status for the round. It protects traffic and crews against specified physical threats. It does not raise Beacon or enable passage below 2. Hidden effects may also depend on the final funded orders.

Damage: a disabled asset or lost crew is unavailable for the rest of this prototype, including the ending. Surviving assets return next round. No replacement, retraining or recovery action exists in this short scenario.

Ductus Guild

SHARED BRIEF | TWO PLAYERS

We can carry your army, your food or our own obligations. The same ship cannot be in three places.

You operate the local passage service. Your navigators learn over decades to interpret the immaterial deep; soldiers cannot substitute for them. The immediate problem is the Narrow's worn physical beacon and the demands placed on its ships, not a spell that repairs the void.

Starting assets	Use
Wayfarer - freight vessel	Offer to Navigation, or complete a private commercial contract.
Lantern - survey tender	Offer to Navigation, or Maintain the beacon independently.

Your shared priorities

Protect your people: keep Lantern's navigation team alive and finish with Beacon 2+.
Protect your institution: secure a formal answer to GUILD-14 and protected Guild navigation rights. Prefer N-G's discretion; N-J trades that discretion for a voice over every Navigation order. N-I recognises the licence but leaves traffic priorities to the crown.
Meet your obligations: two commercial contracts are due, one each round. Record how many you complete. Neither paid work nor safe passage should be taken for granted.
Keep the region viable: aim for Communities 2+.

A petition, not a charity charter

Your navigation rights petition has waited fourteen years. The monopoly concerns expertise, licensing and associated services. The articles in this prototype settle licensed passage and duty of service; wider communications rights remain reserved to a later instrument. Every printed option gives a formal response, but on different terms.

You do not automatically give civilian cargo priority. You may do so because people need help, the region sustains your business, or someone offers an acceptable bargain. A compulsory military service duty is a real concession even when you willingly carry troops today.

At the two tables

Your Navigation delegate bargains over the ships and the navigation instrument. Your Security delegate can secure Guard for a risky private voyage or for Lantern's exposed crew, and can negotiate limits on the army's activity. Write one request for each delegate before separating.

Choices you can make alone

Wayfarer Trade uses your own ship and needs no outsider's permission. Lantern Maintain likewise acts without council approval. Both may leave a council order without its required asset. Trade can succeed while imperial relief fails; it can also expose your ship to attack if protection and beacon preparation are inadequate.

You cannot retrain a lost navigation team during this game. Returning perception in veterans is a possible subject for future research, not a supply of qualified navigators.

Janissariat

SHARED BRIEF | TWO PLAYERS

They ask what our soldiers will do when the fighting ends. We are beginning to ask the same question.

Your conditioning was made for war. Without qualifying fighting it frays, weakening combat power and loosening the habits that made the army a dependable imperial instrument. Soldiers begin questioning and sensing things they were trained to suppress. That may be a future for your people. It is a threat to the institution you currently command.

Starting assets	Use
Spear - the 9th Pale Cohort	Offer to Security, launch an independent Raid, or Stand down. It has local assault craft; an external Campaign needs Guild passage.
Vigil - the Narrow garrison	Offer to Security and possible imperial Warrant, or remain Home. Home is an institutional duty, not a Readiness bonus.

Your shared priorities

Keep a capable force: aim for Readiness 3+, preferably 4, and an intact Spear cohort.
Secure your institution: prefer M-A's autonomous order. M-J buys legitimacy but exposes campaigns to another institution's veto. M-I accepts that the crown can direct you to stand down.
Protect your people: do not casually spend Spear at opening Readiness below 2. Conditioning is not the same thing as the welfare of the soldiers who carry it.
Leave somewhere worth defending: aim for Communities 2+.

Your military choices

A **Campaign** seeks a named armed remnant position beyond the route. It requires Military or Shared passage. A **Raid** uses Spear's own local craft to intercept an armed remnant detachment on this side of the crossing. It needs no Guild transport, but the target may not appear. Neither action is an attack on the civilian opposition of Vethis.

Actual successful contact sustains conditioning in this prototype. This deliberately narrows the larger game's deployment/internal-trials rule for the author's requested fighting incentive. No approved internal-trials site is available in this local emergency; its costs and legitimacy are outside this test. Guard, food deliveries and orders that never reach a fight do not qualify.

Authority and loyalty

The Ascendant needs your army and its loyalty while it fights. Low Readiness weakens their ability to use Vigil through an imperial Warrant. You are not instructed to betray the throne if conditioning frays. Your players decide what loyalty means in the resulting settlement.

An independent Raid needs only your faction's signatures. It breaches Interim, M-I or M-J duties; under M-A it is permitted, provided Vigil stays Home. A council Raid is a separate lawful order using offered Spear. Do not assign Spear to both.

Your Navigation delegate secures passage or influences the traffic that might draw a target out. Your Security delegate decides military priorities and constitutional terms. Agree what each is authorised to promise.

The Ascendant

SOLE PLAYER BRIEF

A peace upheld by this army must answer what the army will fight tomorrow.

You want a future that outlives conquest. Your authority rests partly on an army whose conditioning needs fighting. Continued violence may preserve your military foundation while damaging the future you are trying to secure.

Your priorities

Preserve a workable empire: ratify the two instruments with Beacon 1+, Communities 2+ and Readiness 2+.
Keep the army you need: prefer Readiness 3+ and an intact Spear. At low Readiness your independent Warrant capability is lost.
Retain room to govern: prefer at least one imperial article. Sharing both domains is a substantial constitutional concession.
Account for your rule: name the people who paid for the settlement you secured.

Foresight

In each faction phase choose **Navigation** or **Security**. Read that round's matching vision; the other remains unseen. The card reveals fixed consequences conditional on choices, never what another player will choose. You may show, describe, conceal or misrepresent it. The facilitator does not certify your claims to the others.

Every printed consequence applies whether its vision is read or not. No rewind, extra question or improvised prophecy changes the rules. Averting a condition means the prophecy was successfully avoided, not that it was false.

Imperial Warrant - an army-backed power

Requirement: Interim or M-I military authority, opening Readiness 3+, and Vigil offered to Security.
Cost: assign Vigil to the Warrant before the council bell.
Effect: Communities +1 and guarded status. Security may still use offered Spear for a different order. It cannot also use Vigil for Guard.

If you issue a Warrant under Interim/M-I but lack Readiness or offered Vigil, it fails: Communities -1. Outside those articles it is only advice, with no effect or penalty. Under M-J the delegates may choose Guard; you have lost the power to order it independently. Your formal title cannot replace military support.

One prepared intervention

Your reserve is the **Grey Petrel**, a contracted light cutter with its own licensed Guild pilot and a small protection detail. Its contract covers one intervention during the entire game. Before councils, lodge **Relief lift**, **Tender cover** or Keep on your worksheet. The exact triggers are printed there. The cutter cannot carry the cohort, repair the beacon or solve both councils' problems.

Your place in government

You attend Security and send public written directions to Navigation where you hold authority. Every provisional article needs your assent; the final package needs your signature. You cannot revoke provisional powers during round two. Delegation changes what you can do, not merely what title appears on a card.

Commit these assets

CUT INTO FOUR | KEEP EACH CARD WITH ITS OWNER

WAYFARER | Guild freight vessel

Choose each round: Council or Trade. One assignment only.

Council: may pay for Relief, Military or Shared passage. It cannot also complete a commercial contract.

Trade: independent voyage. Prepared Beacon 3+, or 2 with Guard/Warrant: complete 1 contract. At 2 unguarded: disabled, no contract. Below 2: voyage halted; intact, no contract.

Wear: every crossing uses 1 Beacon. Mark DISABLED if attacked; unavailable thereafter. Cargo crew survive.

LANTERN | Guild survey tender

Choose each round: Council or Maintain. One assignment only.

Maintain: prepared Beacon +1; no council use.

Council: pays for Repair (+2 prepared Beacon), or combines with Wayfarer for Shared passage. Its space and navigators support mixed loading; it cannot repair during that voyage.

Risk: fixed hidden consequences may threaten the crew. Guard/Warrant protects against specified physical threats only. If crew are lost, mark LOST and remove this card for the rest of the game.

SPEAR | 9th Pale Cohort

Choose each round: Council, independent Raid or Stand down.

Council: pays for Campaign or council Raid. Campaign also needs delivered Military/Shared passage.

Raid: uses its own local craft; no transport or outside consent. Target presence is hidden. Target present + opening Readiness 2+: combat. Below 2 with target present: disabled. Target absent: no combat, intact.

Conditioning: successful combat gives Readiness +1; otherwise -1 once per round. Stand down gives no recovery bonus. Disabled Spear cannot act again.

VIGIL | Narrow garrison

Choose each round: Council or Home.

Council: can pay for Guard or, under Interim/M-I at opening Readiness 3+, an imperial Warrant. One use only. Warrant has first claim if validly issued.

Guard/Warrant: Communities +1 and guarded status for physical threats. Cannot repair Beacon or enable a voyage below prepared Beacon 2.

Home: protects military institutional bases; no numerical bonus. Required under M-A. Does not sustain conditioning. Vigil has no loss rule in this prototype.

Council references

CUT INTO TWO | ONE PER TABLE

NAVIGATION AND SUPPLY

Members: Guild and Janissariat delegates. Use only offered Guild cards. Interim/N-I: Ascendant initials; N-G: Guild; N-J: both delegates.

RELIEF - Wayfarer: delivered cargo Communities +2.
MILITARY - Wayfarer: delivered passage enables Campaign; no civilian cargo.
SHARED - Wayfarer + Lantern: delivered cargo Communities +1 and enables Campaign.
REPAIR - Lantern: prepared Beacon +2; no voyage.
HOLD - free: no operation.

Passage: prepare Beacon using Maintain/Repair, cap 0-4. Voyage requires 2+. Each crossing then costs Beacon -1. Halted council voyage gives no cargo/passage and Communities -1. A missing required asset means Hold and Communities -1 instead.

Round one: also propose N-G/N-I/N-J. Both delegates and Ascendant sign separately. Round two tests that power and duty. All orders and proposals lock at council bell.

SECURITY AND GOVERNMENT

Members: both faction delegates and Ascendant. Interim/M-I: Ascendant initials; M-A: Janissariat; M-J: both delegates.

CAMPAIGN - Spear + delivered Military/Shared passage: Communities -1. Opening Readiness 2+: combat; below 2: Spear disabled. Without passage: Communities -1, no combat, Spear intact.
RAID - Spear: Communities -1; hidden condition determines target. If present at Readiness 2+, combat and a further Communities -1. If present below 2, Spear disabled.
GUARD - Vigil: Communities +1 and guarded status.
RESTRAINT - free: no operation.

Warrant: valid imperial Warrant uses Vigil first. Do not spend it again. Missing required offered card defaults to Restraint and Communities -1. Independent Spear cannot pay a council order.

Readiness: one change each round: +1 after successful combat; otherwise -1. Food and Guard do not qualify. Round one: propose M-I/M-A/M-J with both delegates and Ascendant signing. Lock at council bell.

Round 1 decision cards

CUT INTO FOUR | ONE BINDING CARD PER FACTION AND COUNCIL

R1-G | Guild commitment

Circle one per available asset:
Wayfarer: COUNCIL / TRADE / ABSENT
Lantern: COUNCIL / MAINTAIN / ABSENT

Default: Trade and Maintain. An unavailable asset is Absent. Both teammates must sign the assignments.

Navigation request: _____
Security request: _____

Both signatures: _____
_____

Lock: faction bell. No later reassignment. Duties apply even when an asset is absent.

R1-J | Janissariat commitment

Circle one per available asset:
Spear: COUNCIL / RAID / STAND DOWN / ABSENT
Vigil: COUNCIL / HOME

Default: Stand down and Home. Independent Raid needs no other party's consent. It can breach your current duty.

Navigation request: _____
Security request: _____

Both signatures: _____
_____

Lock: faction bell. Offered means available for council use, not a second assignment.

R1-N | Navigation order

The Narrow must carry both relief and military traffic. Its beacon begins at 2.

Circle one: RELIEF / MILITARY / SHARED / REPAIR / HOLD

Asset costs and effects: council reference.
Required authority initials: _____

Separate constitutional proposal:
Proposal: N-G / N-I / N-J
Guild ____ Janissariat ____ Ascendant ____

Lock: council bell. Invalid/missing order: Hold. Valid order without an asset: Hold and Communities -1.

R1-S | Security order

The external remnant position can be reached by military passage. A local detachment may expose itself to a Raid.

Circle one: CAMPAIGN / RAID / GUARD / RESTRAINT

Asset costs and effects: council reference.
Required authority initials: _____

Separate constitutional proposal:
Proposal: M-I / M-A / M-J
Guild ____ Janissariat ____ Ascendant ____

Lock: council bell. Check whether a Warrant already uses Vigil. Independent Spear is unavailable here.

Round 2 decision cards

CUT INTO FOUR | ONE BINDING CARD PER FACTION AND COUNCIL

R2-G | Guild commitment

Circle one per available asset:
Wayfarer: COUNCIL / TRADE / ABSENT
Lantern: COUNCIL / MAINTAIN / ABSENT

Default: Trade and Maintain. An unavailable asset is Absent. Both teammates must sign the assignments.

Navigation request: _____
Security request: _____

Both signatures: _____
_____

Lock: faction bell. No later reassignment. Duties apply even when an asset is absent.

R2-J | Janissariat commitment

Circle one per available asset:
Spear: COUNCIL / RAID / STAND DOWN / ABSENT
Vigil: COUNCIL / HOME

Default: Stand down and Home. Independent Raid needs no other party's consent. It can breach your current duty.

Navigation request: _____
Security request: _____

Both signatures: _____
_____

Lock: faction bell. Offered means available for council use, not a second assignment.

R2-N | Navigation order

A month has passed. Damaged ships and lost crews remain unavailable. Read the new article before issuing orders.

Circle one: RELIEF / MILITARY / SHARED / REPAIR / HOLD

Asset costs and effects: council reference.
Required authority initials: _____

Separate constitutional proposal:
Current article: INTERIM / N-G / N-I / N-J
No article changes during this round.

Lock: council bell. Invalid/missing order: Hold. Valid order without an asset: Hold and Communities -1.

R2-S | Security order

The remnant detachment has changed its movements. Last month's Raid condition no longer applies.

Circle one: CAMPAIGN / RAID / GUARD / RESTRAINT

Asset costs and effects: council reference.
Required authority initials: _____

Separate constitutional proposal:
Current article: INTERIM / M-I / M-A / M-J
No article changes during this round.

Lock: council bell. Check whether a Warrant already uses Vigil. Independent Spear is unavailable here.

Navigation instruments

CUT INTO THREE | EACH SETTLES GUILD-14 FOR LICENSED PASSAGE

N-G | Guild discretion

Power: Guild delegate chooses Navigation. Guild licensing and discretion over traffic are protected. Wider communications rights remain undecided.

Duty: each operational round, use Lantern for independent Maintain or a funded council Repair. Failure causes Communities -1. You may physically disobey; the order is not cancelled.

Resources and sacrifice: upkeep occupies Lantern, preventing Shared passage that round unless you break the duty. Wayfarer may Trade. The army must bargain for a military lift; Guild discretion does not mean automatic civilian priority.

Effect: begins next round if both delegates and Ascendant sign. At the Ceremony, establishes the continuing right and upkeep obligation.

N-I | Imperial priority

Power: Ascendant chooses Navigation. Guild licensing is recognised, but the crown determines traffic priorities. Wider communications rights remain undecided.

Duty: offer Wayfarer to Navigation every operational round. If it is withheld or unavailable, Communities -1. The crown cannot seize it or convert that penalty into an asset.

Resources and sacrifice: offering Wayfarer forgoes that round's commercial contract, even if the council leaves it idle. Lantern remains the Guild's assignment choice. All printed order costs still apply.

Effect: begins next round with all three proposal signatures. At the Ceremony, establishes the continuing licence and imperial service obligation.

N-J | Joint authorisation

Power: both Navigation delegates must agree the order. Without both initials, Hold. Guild licensing is protected; neither crown nor Guild chooses traffic alone.

Duty: offer Wayfarer to Navigation every operational round. If withheld or unavailable, Communities -1. Lantern remains the Guild's assignment choice.

Resources and sacrifice: Guild gives up a commercial voyage and sole discretion; Janissariat accepts a Guild veto over passage; Ascendant gives up independent priority-setting. There is no cheaper ship or extra cargo for agreeing.

Effect: begins next round with all three proposal signatures. At the Ceremony, establishes continuing shared authority and service. Wider communications rights remain reserved.

Military instruments

CUT INTO THREE | LEGAL AUTHORITY DOES NOT PREVENT AN ATTEMPT

M-I | Imperial command

Power: Ascendant chooses Security. At opening Readiness 3+, offered Vigil can also serve an independent imperial Warrant. Spear remains an imperial instrument that can be stood down.

Duty: offer Spear to Security every operational round. Withholding, an independent Raid or a disabled Spear breaks this duty: Communities -1 once. Council-directed Raid is lawful.

Resources and sacrifice: the army surrenders its freedom to choose fighting; the crown bears responsibility for sustaining conditioning or accepting its decline. Vigil is still offered voluntarily. No decree creates either asset.

M-A | Military autonomy

Power: Janissariat delegate chooses Security. Spear is part of an autonomous order and may also Raid independently. The Ascendant has no independent Warrant power.

Duty: keep Vigil Home every operational round to protect the order's bases. Offering it instead breaks the duty: Communities -1. You may still offer and use it; the physical action remains possible.

Resources and sacrifice: preserving the order's separate base removes Vigil from civilian Guard unless the duty is broken. Independent fighting may preserve Readiness while harming Communities. Autonomy does not add strength or make resting restorative.

M-J | Joint authorisation

Power: both Security delegates must agree. Without both initials, Restraint. The Ascendant loses independent Warrant power. The military accepts outside scrutiny and a veto over its lawful operations.

Duty: offer Spear to Security every operational round. Withholding, an independent Raid or a disabled Spear causes Communities -1 once. A jointly approved council Raid is lawful; its ordinary civilian costs still apply.

Resources and sacrifice: Guard still uses Vigil. The council chooses between using Spear for fighting or Vigil for Guard; it cannot take two orders. Delay or restraint can let conditioning fray. The crown and Guild must decide what violence they will support.

Imperial worksheet

ASCENDANT | TWO PUBLIC DIRECTIVES AND ONE RESERVE VESSEL

Grey Petrel - one contract, two possible tasks

A light cutter with a licensed Guild pilot and a protection detail, already contracted before the crisis. It is an imperial reserve asset, not newly created navigation capacity. Lodge one task at the faction bell. It cannot be reassigned during councils.

Intervention	Printed trigger and effect
Relief lift	If the final authorised Navigation order is Relief and Wayfarer is not offered, Grey Petrel supplies that ship requirement. Spend the reserve immediately, even if prepared Beacon later halts the voyage. It cannot supply Military or Shared passage.
Tender cover	If the round-one Shared voyage crosses, is unguarded, and its printed crew-loss consequence would trigger, spend the reserve to protect Lantern's navigation team. No Community bonus, Beacon repair or other protection.
Keep / no trigger	Keep leaves the reserve available. A lodged intervention whose trigger does not occur returns unused at round end. Tender cover has no trigger in round two.

Place the reserve coin beside the lodged task. Once spent, mark Grey Petrel SPENT and remove the coin. An intervention never counts as Vigil Guard or a military operation. A missed or multiple selection means Keep.

Round one

Vision: NAVIGATION / SECURITY / NONE
Reserve: KEEP / RELIEF LIFT / TENDER COVER
Navigation directive: _____
Security directive: _____
Imperial Warrant: YES / NO Ascendant initials: _____

Round two

Vision: NAVIGATION / SECURITY / NONE
Reserve: KEEP / RELIEF LIFT / TENDER COVER / ALREADY SPENT
Navigation directive: _____
Security directive: _____
Imperial Warrant: YES / NO Ascendant initials: _____

Deadlines

Vision and intervention: faction bell. Directives and Warrant: council bell. Transfer each lawful final directive to its council card and initial there. That card supersedes earlier notes. A Warrant remains on this sheet and has first claim on offered Vigil. A late, unsigned, missing or multiple Warrant selection means No.

Warrant check: Interim/M-I + opening Readiness 3+ + offered Vigil. Valid: Communities +1 and guarded. Missing Readiness/Vigil: Communities -1. Outside Interim/M-I: advice only. A simultaneous council Guard cannot reuse Vigil and defaults with Communities -1.

The Narrow - public record

KEEP VISIBLE | USE THREE COUNTERS AND ASSET CARDS

Track	0	1	2	3	4
Beacon			START		
Communities				START	
Readiness				START	

Permanent record	Current state
Wayfarer	READY / DISABLED
Lantern navigation team	ALIVE / LOST
Spear cohort	READY / DISABLED
Vigil garrison	Available each round; its assignment still matters
Grey Petrel reserve	AVAILABLE / LODGED / SPENT
Guild commercial contracts	0 / 1 / 2 completed

Authority and duties

Round	Navigation	Military
1	INTERIM	INTERIM
2	INTERIM / N-G / N-I / N-J	INTERIM / M-I / M-A / M-J

Interim: Ascendant chooses both council orders. No Guild service duty. An independent Janissariat Raid breaks imperial discipline: Communities -1. Offered Vigil can serve a Warrant at opening Readiness 3+. This is also the constitutional fallback if final ratification fails.

Resolution record

Record	Round one	Round two
Opening B / C / R	2 / 3 / 3	____ / ____ / ____
Prepared Beacon	____	____
Navigation / Security	_____ / _____	_____ / _____
Guard or Warrant?	YES / NO	YES / NO
Commercial voyage completed?	YES / NO	YES / NO
Successful combat?	YES / NO	YES / NO
Duty broken: Guild / army	YES / NO ; YES / NO	YES / NO ; YES / NO
Final B / C / R	____ / ____ / ____	____ / ____ / ____

Before play - constitutional preferences

Guild preferred N article: _____ Military preference: _____
Janissariat preferred N article: _____ Military preference: _____
Ascendant preferred N article: _____ Military preference: _____

These are statements of preference, not binding votes or secret personal objectives. Compare them with the final bargain during the debrief.

Ceremony of Settlement

ONE PACKAGE | THREE PARTIES | FIVE PLAYER APPROVALS

The wider Charter awaits these two instruments. You have ten minutes. All six printed alternatives remain available, including those not tested. Choose one of each. No handwritten clause can create resources, cancel losses or change printed rules.

Choose the package

Navigation: N-G GUILD DISCRETION / N-I IMPERIAL PRIORITY / N-J JOINT AUTHORISATION
Military: M-I IMPERIAL COMMAND / M-A MILITARY AUTONOMY / M-J JOINT AUTHORISATION

Approval	Guild: both initials	Janissariat: both initials	Ascendant
First package	_____	_____	_____
Replacement	_____	_____	_____

Both teammates must agree before their faction signs. Any player may withdraw their own approval before the deadline. If either article changes, obtain all five approvals again on a new row. The last complete row for the current package is binding.

State at settlement

Beacon ____ /4 Communities ____ /4 Readiness ____ /4
Wayfarer READY / DISABLED Lantern crew ALIVE / LOST
Spear READY / DISABLED Commercial contracts ____ /2
Grey Petrel AVAILABLE / SPENT

Party	What we secured	What we gave up
Guild	_____	_____
Janissariat	_____	_____
Ascendant	_____	_____

At the deadline

All approvals present: the instruments are ratified. Their continuing rights and duties enter the wider Charter; prearranged sanctification and formalities follow. No extra round or recovery occurs.
Any approval missing: the provisional articles expire. Interim legal arrangements return. Existing damage, losses, contracts and tracks remain. Low Readiness still weakens imperial enforcement; a title does not restore the army.

Debrief - six minutes

1. Did experience change your preferred article? Name the specific event.
2. What did each party give up for cooperation? Was any concession merely cosmetic?
3. Was unilateral action a credible alternative? What made it attractive or dangerous?
4. Did a named asset make a promise or loss feel concrete? Which card was confusing?
5. Did the Ascendant learn something useful without solving both tables alone?
6. Did both teammates contribute? Record one change for the next test.